Egg Washer



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Egg Washer

What it is used for

An egg washer removes surface dirt from eggs using a controlled washing process designed for the equipment and egg-handling facility. Correct water conditions, approved cleaning agents, gentle handling, and hygienic drying help reduce contamination and egg damage.

Main parts

- Egg infeed conveyor or loading rack
- Wash chamber and spray nozzles or brushes
- Water supply, valves, and temperature controls
- Approved detergent dosing system where fitted
- Rinse section and drainage system
- Outfeed conveyor, guards, and control panel

Before you start

1. Confirm that the washer is approved for the type of eggs and the facility's food-safety process.
2. Inspect the wash chamber, brushes, nozzles, conveyors, guards, hoses, and drainage system for damage or residue.
3. Verify that the water supply meets the facility's approved quality and temperature requirements for egg washing.
4. Use only cleaning agents approved for the equipment and process, following the specified concentration and instructions.
5. Check that drainage is clear and that washed eggs can move to the next approved drying or handling stage without recontamination.
6. Wear clean protective clothing and follow handwashing, biosecurity, and egg-handling procedures.

How to use

1. Switch off and isolate power before adjusting brushes, guides, or other moving components.
2. Set the water temperature, flow rate, and cleaning-agent concentration according to the validated facility procedure and equipment instructions.
3. Confirm that the spray system, brushes, and drainage are operating correctly before loading eggs.
4. Start the washer using the approved control and allow the system to reach the required operating conditions.
5. Place eggs onto the infeed conveyor in the correct orientation and avoid crowding or impact.

6. Feed eggs at a controlled rate so that the washing action reaches the intended surfaces without excessive friction.
7. Monitor water temperature, flow, detergent dosing, brush movement, and drainage during operation.
8. Inspect washed eggs for remaining soil, cracks, damaged shells, and residue; follow the site's rejection criteria.
9. Stop the machine if water conditions leave the approved limits, a nozzle blocks, a leak occurs, or eggs are being damaged.
10. Do not allow dirty wash water to contaminate clean eggs or downstream handling areas.
11. At the end of the batch, stop the infeed and follow the approved shutdown and draining procedure.
12. Remove retained debris and clean the chamber, brushes, nozzles, and conveyors according to the sanitation schedule.
13. Record required operating checks, cleaning completion, and any rejected eggs or process deviations.

⚠ Safety

- Only trained personnel should operate and clean the egg washer.
- Use only the approved water conditions and cleaning agents; unsuitable washing can increase contamination risk or damage egg shells.
- Keep hands away from moving brushes, rollers, and conveyors while the machine is running.
- Switch off and isolate power before clearing blocked nozzles, removing debris, or servicing moving parts.
- Prevent water from entering electrical controls and use the required electrical protection for wet areas.
- Wear appropriate gloves and eye protection when handling cleaning chemicals and follow their safety labels.
- Handle broken eggs and contaminated wash water according to the facility's hygiene and waste procedures.

Care & storage

- Clean and sanitise the chamber, brushes, nozzles, conveyors, and contact surfaces at the required frequency.
- Inspect brushes, seals, hoses, valves, and spray nozzles for wear, leaks, or blockage.
- Check water temperature controls, detergent dosing, and drainage performance regularly.
- Remove scale and deposits using approved products and methods.
- Arrange servicing if water temperature fluctuates, spray coverage becomes uneven, or shell damage increases.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using water conditions or cleaning agents that are not approved for the process.
- Overloading the infeed and causing eggs to collide or crack.
- Allowing dirty water or contaminated surfaces to contact washed eggs.

- Cleaning or clearing the machine while moving parts remain active.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.